HOW TO…Couplings

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1 Introduction

This document describes a step-by-step guide to producing a 3 link chain coupling from scratch.

A word about the examples in this/these documents.

We used the modeling package 3D Studio max to create Rail Simulator, so this product appears in the examples we have provided. You can, of course, use other packages such as Blender or 3D Canvas. The package we used for authoring textures is Adobe Photoshop, again you may use one of the many other packages available. Regardless of the packages you use, the document should be used as a general guide to the processes to follow to build assets for Rail Simulator

Important note: For your chosen package, you may need additional plug-ins to export the assets into Rail Simulator. We are in the process of finalising these tools and so plug-ins for some packages may not be available immediately.

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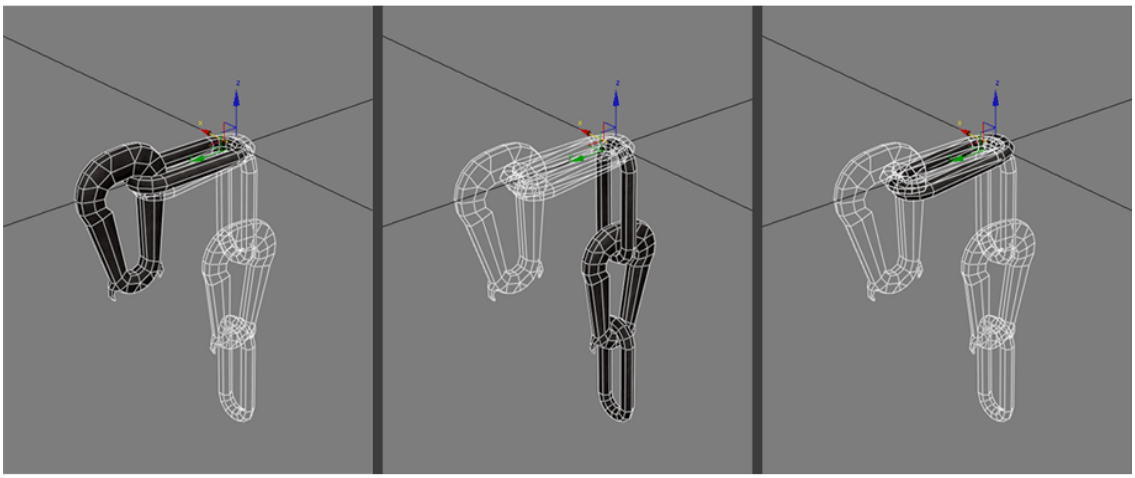
2 The 3 object states of couplings

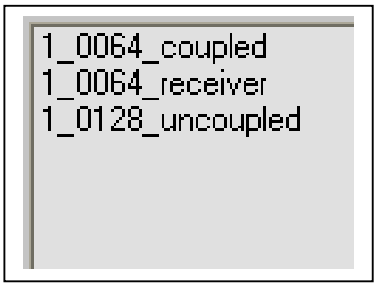
This section will run through the process of creating the 3 link chain coupling.

2.1 Create the 3 object states (in 3DSMax)

1. Couplers consist of 3 objects, ***coupled***, ***uncoupled*** *and* ***receiving***.
   - The ***coupled*** state is an object that reflects a coupling when 2 wagons or engines are connected.
   - The ***uncoupled*** state is an object that reflects a coupling that is not connected to another wagon or engine.
   - The ***receiving*** state is the point where the coupling attaches to the target wagon or engine.
2. All 3 object pivot points should be positioned where the coupler meets the parent wagon or engine.
3. All 3 objects should then be positioned at 0,0,0 with in 3dsmax.



4. Each object needs naming correctly for the code to work correctly.



5. Export each object state individually.
6. These are then referenced in a coupling blueprint and then subsequently referenced in the wagon or engine blueprint.

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3 Other coupling types

3.1 Other coupling types

1. For coupling types that don't use a receiving point, such as the buckeye only ***coupled*** and ***uncoupled*** objects are required.

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